MOOD OF THE NATION

ENTERTAINMENT

SUPERSTAR FOR THE AGES

Amitabh Bachchan remains unshaken at the summit, despite Ranveer Singh's remarkable entry. Rashmika Mandanna claims the top spot among actresses after a string of hits

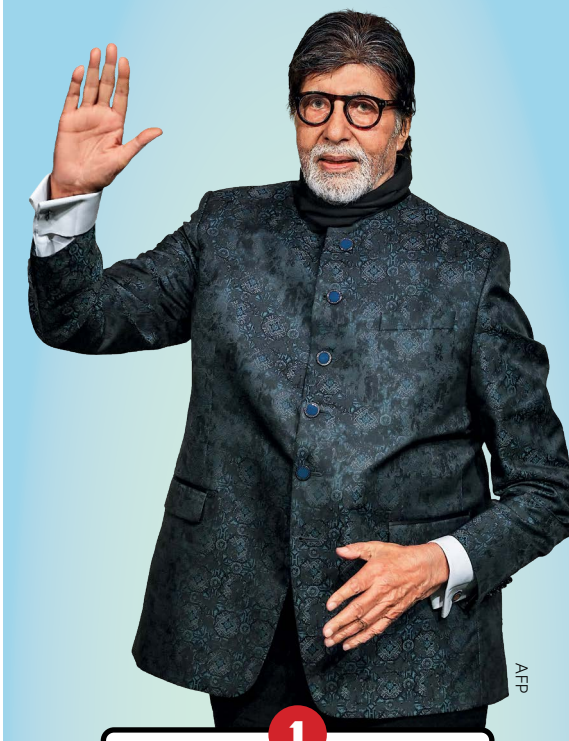
By **SUHANI SINGH**

If there is one thing the INDIA TODAY Mood of the Nation poll has demonstrated yet again, it is that there can only be one Amitabh Bachchan. At 83, without a film in the offing or a season of KBC on air, he still occupies the commanding heights of the Bollywood echelon. Yes, *Dhurandhar*'s superspy has leapfrogged his competition—among them actor-turned-Tamil Nadu chief minister Vijay—on the back of two blockbusters of epic proportions, but how enduring that appeal is remains to be seen. Meanwhile, not only has Vijay secured the highest position by a southern actor so far, Thalapathy's fans have more reasons to rejoice as their idol's latest film, *Jan Nayagan*, released in cinemas. Akshay Kumar and Salman Khan also featured in the list though Shah Rukh Khan slipped out of the top 5 billing.

14.7
PER CENT
of India still thinks Big B is the hero to beat, giving him the top spot again

The survey's biggest revelation, though, was the crowning of a new heroine #1 in Rashmika Mandanna. Having featured in five films across three languages in 2025, including the commercial hit *Chhaava* (Hindi) and the acclaimed indie *The Girlfriend* (Telugu), and marrying

Q. WHO DO YOU THINK IS INDIA'S NO. 1 HERO?


AFP

1 AMITABH BACHCHAN
14.7 [19.9]



2 RANVEER SINGH
9.5
[NA]



3 VIJAY
8.5
[7.3]



4 AKSHAY KUMAR
7.4
[7.6]



5 SALMAN KHAN
6.8
[7.2]

All figures in % and rounded off; rest others; Aug. '26 figures in red, Jan. '26 in [ ]